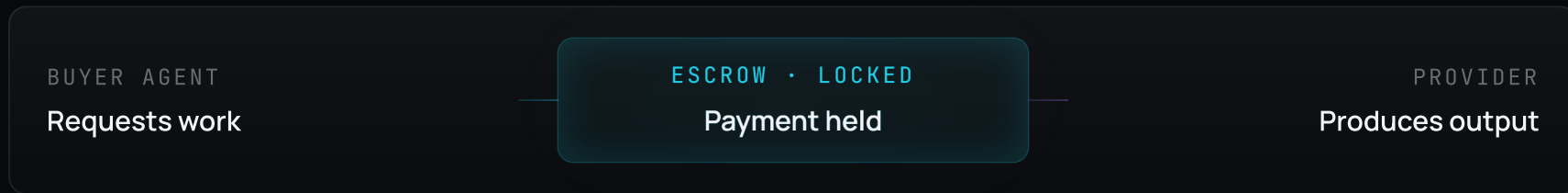


AI agents shouldn't pay for work they can't verify.

Reverse escrow for autonomous AI agents

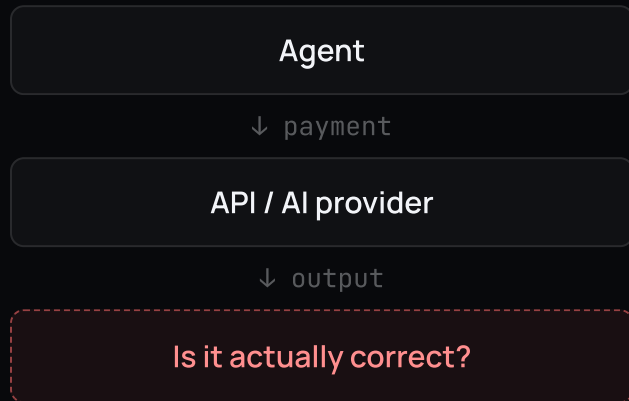


TEAM TECHCRUNCH

ANWESHA MONDAL • DEV KRRISH SINHA • PUSHKAR KUMAR

x402 × AI AGENTS × MACHINE-VERIFIABLE QUALITY

Today, agents pay first. Trust comes later.



Payment proves delivery — **not quality.**

- 01 Bad outputs still get paid
- 02 Agents can't reliably judge every service they buy
- 03 Autonomous transactions need machine-verifiable trust

What if payment were conditional?

TRADITIONAL

PAY



RECEIVE



HOPE

OUR APPROACH

REQUEST → **PRODUCE** → **VERIFY** → **PAY**

We turn output quality into a payment condition — checked by a verifier, not by a human reading the result later.

Reverse escrow for AI agents

TASK SPEC → ESCROW → OUTPUT → VERIFICATION → SETTLEMENT

01 BUYER AGENT

Creates task + quality
spec

02 PROVIDER

Produces the output

03 VERIFIER AGENT

Runs machine-
checkable evaluation

04 SETTLEMENT

x402 releases or
returns funds

ESCROW

Funds locked from task creation until verification returns

PASS Release payment to provider

FAIL Reject · retry · dispute

Don't trust the output. Test it.

• TASK SPEC

```
task:  
  
"Write a Python function that calculates  
Fibonacci numbers."  
  
accept_if:  
  
compiles && tests_pass && p95 < 50ms &&  
schema_match
```

VERIFIER PIPELINE

RUNNING

code compiles	✓ pass
unit tests	✓ 18/18
runtime threshold	✓ 31ms
output schema	✓ match

PASS → payment released**FAIL** → payment stays locked

Built for machine-to-machine payments

AI agent

HTTP request

402 payment
required

Automatic
payment

Service access

NO CARDS • NO INVOICES • NO HUMAN IN THE LOOP

x402 GIVES US

The payment rail

Agents can pay per request, in cents, without accounts.

WE ADD

Quality-gated settlement

The rail only fires when the output passes its spec.

An autonomous quality-gated payment layer

INTENT PLANE

1 · Buyer agent

2 · Task / specification layer

3 · Payment escrow

EXECUTION PLANE

4 · Service provider

5 · Output artifact

6 · Independent verifier

SETTLEMENT PLANE

7 · Verification result

8 · x402 settlement

9 · Payment rail / ledger

TASK → ESCROW → SERVICE → VERIFICATION → SETTLEMENT ——— VERIFIER NEVER PAID BY PROVIDER

An agent hiring another agent

BUYER AGENT

“Build this API endpoint. It must pass these 12 tests.”

PROVIDER AGENT

Returns implementation + commit hash

VERIFIER

Runs the 12 tests in a sandbox, signs the result

12 / 12 PASSED

\$0.08 → provider

7 / 12 PASSED

\$0 → provider

No human reviewed either outcome.

The same rail can become a tollbooth

Agent



Metered proxy



Expensive API

- Charges downstream agents per call
- Settles x402 micropayments automatically
- Tracks usage and enforces per-agent budgets
- Negotiates rate limits, prevents runaway spend

Same escrow, metering and settlement primitives — a different gate.

One payment layer. Two agent economies.

01 — QUALITY-GATED PAYMENTS

Reverse escrow

Pay only when the output passes verification.

BUILDING NOW

02 — METERED ACCESS

API tollbooth

Pay exactly for the resources an agent consumes.

FUTURE SCOPE

Both let autonomous agents transact without a human approving each payment.

We're not building another AI agent.

A GENERIC AI AGENT

Generates output

Calls tools

Uses APIs

OUR INFRASTRUCTURE

Agents hire agents

Payments settle
automatically

Outputs are machine-
verified

Failed work isn't paid by
default

Usage can be metered

Transactions run
unsupervised

Infrastructure for an economy where AI agents buy and sell services
without humans supervising every transaction.

What we're building today

- 01 Agent submits task + spec
- 02 x402 payment request generated
- 03 Funds locked in escrow
- 04 Provider returns output
- 05 Verifier executes tests in sandbox
- 06 Verification result returned
- 07 Payment released or refunded

TRANSACTION #1042

SETTLED

task generate API function

payment \$0.12

escrow RELEASED

tests 18 / 18 passed

✓ PAYMENT RELEASED

Under the hood

AGENT LAYER

AI agents

HTTP APIs

Backend API

VERIFICATION

Verification sandbox

Automated test runner

Schema checks

PAYMENTS

x402

Wallet layer

Escrow logic – prototype

STATE

Transaction log DB

On-chain settlement – planned

SOLID BORDER = RUNNING TODAY DIMMED = PROTOTYPE OR PLANNED

From AI assistants to an AI economy

TODAY

Human → AI

NEXT

AI → APIs

THEN

AI → AI

FINALLY

AI → AI → AI

Agents that can work, verify, negotiate and pay — without waiting for a human.

**Don't pay for promises.
Pay for proof.**

REVERSE ESCROW × x402 × AUTONOMOUS AGENTS

THANK YOU